Entrepreneur to Leader

Unit 1 · 1.3.4.5 Managing people

As a start-up grows, the founder must shift from **entrepreneur** (doing everything, deciding everything) to **leader** (setting direction and working through others).

Common difficulties

- **Delegation** — an owner used to running everything may struggle to hand over control, creating a bottleneck that slows decisions.
- **Changing leadership style** — the early autocratic approach may not suit a larger team that expects more say, risking low morale and turnover.
- **New skills & responsibilities** — leading needs vision, communication and people-management rather than hands-on doing.

Overcoming them

Easier in a **small team**, where the founder can delegate routine tasks while keeping major decisions, and where a founder open to change (e.g. already adapting services on customer feedback) can adapt their style gradually.